



Apple Refunds Bill

Apple refunded the £4000 bill raked up by a man's 8-year-old daughter via in-app purchases on his iPad. <http://dgit.in/12GupTe>



Intel's tiny tots

Ever been curious about mini-ITX? Here's Intel's vision of the future <http://dgit.in/15fpgES>

Be a media jockey with XBMC

The definitive guide to becoming an XBMC wiz in no time

Ronak Gupta

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

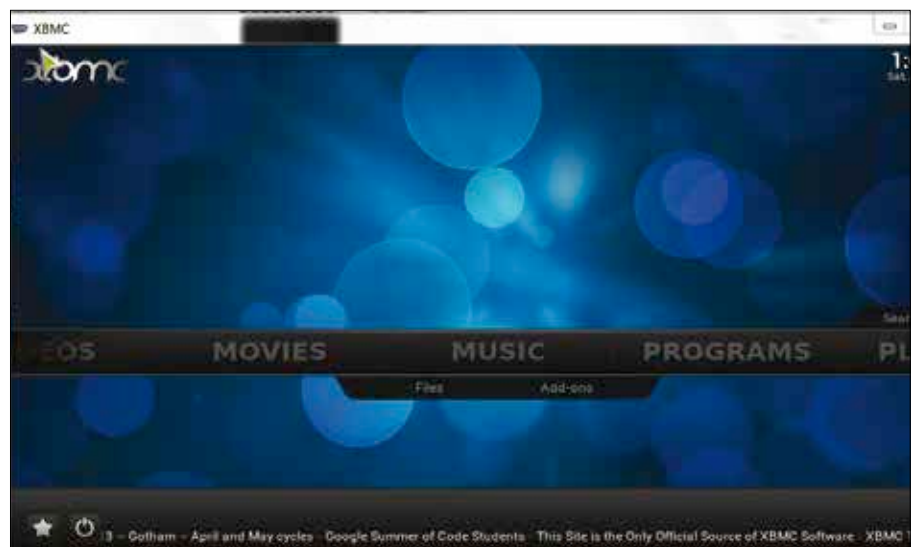
XBMC is a powerful Open Source media centre. It can be categorized as a media hub and a common place for storage of all kinds of digital media. It has some pretty impressive capabilities when it comes to accessing media content and its open source nature guarantees a large number of native add-ons that enhance these capabilities. XBMC is available as an executable package for PC and mobile platforms and there is a stand-alone version that's integrated into a variant of Ubuntu as well. While there's adequate support for Windows, MAC and Linux based systems, this article will concentrate largely on the Windows-based PC application. In this workshop, we'll acquaint you with the software's user interface, basic functionality, customization and some really nifty add-ons.

Installation

Installing XBMC is fairly straightforward and easy. Download the installation file from <http://xbmc.org/download/> and install it to your PC. The process is very straightforward and you can't go wrong.

The UI

XBMC has a simple and clean user interface. It's easy to navigate and adapt to its design. The UI is minimalist and relies heavily on a home screen from where you can head over to different sections, namely, pictures, videos, movies etc. Hovering over any one of these buttons reveals a smaller sub-menu for other



options. The main screen also has a power button on the lower right to exit, power off the system, etc. When you're deeper inside the menu tabs, there are shortcuts for going back and a home button to return to the home screen in the lower screen section. This is what your XBMC will look like by default just after you've installed it. You can customize the UI, add shortcuts and comprehensively tweak it if you want though.

Build your Media Library

Building your media library on XBMC is a simple and intuitive task. But before adding and organizing your media content it might be useful to rename your files to access XBMC's awesome information scraping features. XBMC can download information about media files such as plot summary, poster covers, genre etc. It's a really cool feature! There are a few naming conventions you can

follow. Each movies can be each stored in a separate folder. The folder and the file can be named as title [year]. This convention makes it easy for the software to search for movie-related content. TV series can be renamed as per the conventions listed on the following page: <http://dgit.in/132J9eP>

The lazy people out there can use a renaming software that can be downloaded from <http://www.therenamer.com/>

Once the renaming process is complete it's a cakewalk to set up your library. To add your personal movie collection to XBMC simply go to Videos > Files > Add Videos. Pick the name of your source and specify the type of media ('movie' in this example) in the source folder. XBMC then downloads stills, info, posters etc for movies which you can see the next time you access your movie library. You can add other media content in a similar manner.